

data integrity at both the edge and cloud endpoints. Ensuring the data's accuracy is paramount, guaranteeing that the information transmitted aligns with the intended content.

The pursuit extends to fulfilling the computational demands associated with image recognition. This necessitates efficient computing resources to analyse and process visual data, further enhancing the capabilities and value of our networking applications. Companies like Nvidia are at the forefront of providing the necessary computational power to meet these demands.

Automation in the semiconductor lifecycle

Automating the semiconductor lifecycle is another crucial aspect of the AI revolution in the industry. McKinsey's research suggests that AI could generate \$85 billion to \$95 billion in revenue over the long term, highlighting the untapped potential of AI-driven automation in semiconductor manufacturing. As AI techniques become more advanced, semiconductor companies embrace them to streamline processes and improve operational efficiencies.

The AI revolution is reshaping the semiconductor industry in profound ways. The demand for AI IoT devices is driving the need for increased computational power, sub-micron compute devices, and more reliable

Key driving agents in semiconductor evolution

Several key driving agents have played significant roles in shaping the semiconductor industry over the years:

Technology shift in AI compute requirements

- The semiconductor industry experiencing a technology shift due to rising demand for AI applications
- OEM manufacturers and chip design teams engaged in application benchmarking to assess computational power capabilities
- AI integration into daily life necessitates hardware adaptation to meet increased demands

Surge in demand for sub-micron compute devices

- Computers are shrinking in size while computational demands are on the rise, creating a paradox
- Developing sub-micron computing devices and manufacturing technologies is essential to address this challenge
- Industry must support smaller yet more powerful devices, reduce costs, and ensure reliability

The role of more (reliability, stability, and power efficiency)

- Semiconductor engineers face reliability, stability, and power consumption challenges in sub-micron technology
- Increasing the transistor count on chips necessitates maintaining high-reliability standards
- Ensuring reliability is vital for the seamless operation of AI-powered devices

These driving agents continue to shape the semiconductor industry, with advancements in chip design, manufacturing, and applications leading to ever more powerful and efficient electronic devices.

semiconductor designs. Additionally, the automation of the semiconductor lifecycle through AI promises significant revenue potential. As we continue integrating AI into our daily lives, the semiconductor industry will play a pivotal role in supporting these technological advancements, ultimately shaping the future of our interconnected world.

The semiconductor industry is no stranger to innovation and adaptation. To meet the demands of AI applications, it's crucial to assess whether our chipsets can support various AI tasks effectively. Benchmarking is pivotal in this exploration, comparing AI accelerators across dif-

ferent chipsets by measuring 'TOPs' (tera operations per second).

TOPS is a simplifying metric.

TOPS tells you how many computing operations an AI accelerator can handle in one second at 100% utilisation. In essence, it looks at how many math operation problems an accelerator can solve in a very short period.

What is interesting to note is that scalability in chip design is not always linear. Increasing computational power by merely adding more cores or capacity doesn't guarantee a proportional boost in performance. This highlights the importance of rigorous architectural exploration and benchmarking operations to ensure that AI applications can be handled efficiently by hardware.

Undeniable trend in AI hardware design. Linear scalability is not as straightforward as it may seem. Simply increasing system-on-chip (SoC) capacity and compute power does not necessarily equate to a proportional boost in computational capability. This vital message underscores the need for a deeper exploration of system architecture and comprehensive benchmarking

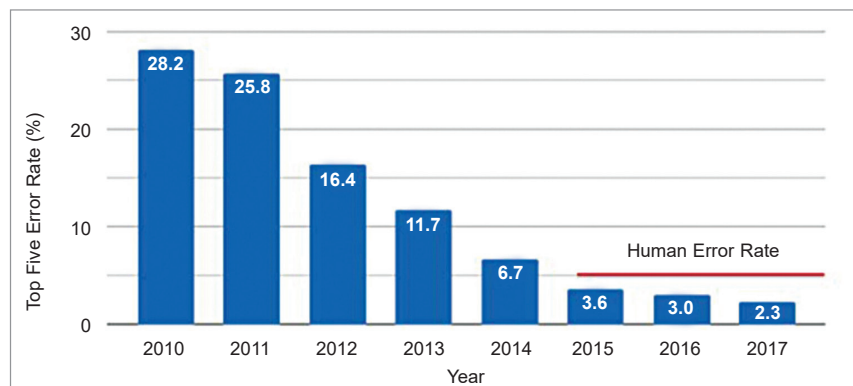


Fig. 2: ImageNet Contest Winning Entry Error Rate (Source: Google)